Tangut Tibetan Transcription Scheme

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Contents

This scheme spells Tangut in Tibetan script. It is based on Gong Xun's reconstruction and aims at simple, natural Tibetan orthography. The scheme is recreational.

1 Initials

Labial		Dental		Alveolar		Palatal		Retroflex		Velar		Uvular		Laryngeal	
p	པ	*t*	ཏ	*ts*	ཙ	*tś*	ཅ	*tṣ*	(ཅ)	*k*	ཀ	*q*	(ཀ)	Ø	ཨ
ph	ཕ	*th*	ཐ	*tsh*	ཚ	*tśh*	ཆ	*tṣh*	(ཆ)	*kh*	ཁ	*qh*	(ཁ)		
b	བ	*d*	ད	*dz*	ཛ	*dź*	ཇ	*dẓ*	(ཇ)	*g*	ག	*ġ*	(ག)		
f	ཕ༹	*lh*	ཐ༹	*s*	ས	*ś*	ཤ	*ṣ*	(ཤ)	*h*	ཧ	*h*	ཧ		
		ll	ད༹	*z*	ཟ	*ź*	ཞ	*ẓ*	(ཞ)	*gh*	ག༹	*ġh*	(ག༹)		
v	བ༹	*l*	ལ			*y*	ཡ	*r*	ར					*w*	ཨྭ
m	མ	*n*	ན					*ṇ*	ཎ			*ŋ*	ང		

The scheme does not distinguish the *tś*/*tṣ* or *k*/*q* initial sets. The latter are conditioned uvularized allophones and remain recoverable from the rhyme grade.

2 Vowels

	a		e		i		o		u		ə	
Grade III	*a*	ཨ	*e*	ཨེ	*i*	ཨི	*o*	ཨོ	*u*	ཨུ	*ə*	ཨྀ
Grade I	*a̱*	ཨའ	*e̱*	ཨའེ	*i̱*	ཨའི	*o̱*	ཨའོ	*u̱*	ཨའུ	*ə̱*	ཨའྀ
Grade II	*aa̱*	ཨཨ	*ae̱*	ཨཨེ	*ai̱*	ཨཨི	*ao̱*	ཨཨོ	*au̱*	ཨཨུ	*aə̱*	ཨཨྀ
Grade IV	*a*	ཨཡ	*e*	ཨཡེ	*i*	ཨཡི	—	—	*u*	ཨཡུ	*ə*	ཨཡྀ

The scheme marks Grades I, II, III, and IV respectively with postposed འ, postposed ཨ, zero, and postposed ཡ. Grade IV comprises R.3, R.11, R.20, R.31, R.37, and R.47. This notation preserves the rhyme books' categorical distinctions: even if Grade IV was probably separated artificially, the scheme still marks it.

3 Non-systemic marks and tones

GX	Tibetan	Category
?	postposed ?	uncertain tone
†	postposed †	other uncertainty (reading evidence, onset, etc.)
^{1}	unmarked	level tone
^{2}	postposed ས	rising tone

4 Segmental features

GX	Tibetan	Category
n-, m-, ŋ-	preposed འ	nasal preinitial
-w-	subjoined ཝ	labial medial
-a-	ཨ	Grade-II medial
-y-	subjoined ཡ	palatal medial
-w	postposed ག།	velar coda
-m̩	postposed མ	nasal coda

GX *vw* is the conditioned Grade-I/II realization after *v*, and its *w* is not written separately; when base ཝ carries a superscript, ◌ྺ is mandatory, while ◌ྭ is reserved for labial *w*. Although based on GX, the scheme also reflects rhyme-table categories: GX merges R.92/R.100 and R.79/R.101, but preposed འ in R.100 and R.101 preserves the rhyme books' distinction.

5 Syllable-wide suprasegmental features

GX	Tibetan	Category
-h	superscribed ས	tense vowel
r-...-r	superscribed ར	retroflex vowel

6 Spelling tests

6.1 Word tests

Tangut	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]
GX	*nye*^{1}	*phu*^{2}	*dźə?*	*świ*^{1}	*baa̱*^{1}	*śeṃ*^{1}	*li̱w*^{1}	*śih*^{2}	*hae̱ṃ*^{2}	*ġhai̱h*^{2}	*rŋo̱ṃr*^{2}	*llo̱ṃh*^{2}	*rġhwe̱r*^{2}
Tibetan	འཇྱེ	ཕྱུས	ཛི?†	ཤྭི	བཨ	ཤེམ	ལའིག	ཤྲིས	ཧཨེམས	སྒཨིས	ཧྤོམས	ལྷོམས	ཀྭའེས

6.2 Sentence tests

Tangut	GX	Tibetan
[illegible]，	*mə̱*^{1} *lləh*^{2} *rur*^{1} *qae̱h*^{2} *ne*^{2}*,*	མའི་སྲིས་རྒྱུ་སྐཨེས་ནཡེས།
[illegible]。	*bi̱*^{2} *lhih*^{2} *tśhə*^{1} *zoh*^{2} *śa*^{2}*.*	བའིས་སྲིས་ཚི་སྲོས་ཤས།།
[illegible]，	*swi̱w*^{1} *na̱*^{1} *ẓaə̱h*^{1} *rtṣai̱r*^{1} *dẓae̱*^{2}*,*	ཤྭའིག་ནའ་སྨྲཨི་རྩཨི་ཛཨེས།
[illegible]。	*tsa*^{1} *da̱h*^{2} *phu*^{2} *bi*^{2} *ŋwe̱*^{2}*.*	ཚཡ་སྤའས་ཕཡུས་བཡིས་ངྭའེས།།

6.3 Paragraph test

Tangut	[illegible]

GX	*dze^{2} ryər^{1}: tha̱^{1} da̱h^{2}: "rtser^{2} le^{2} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1}" yə^{2} ta^{1} thə^{2} vwo̱^{2} the^{2} so^{2}? ndze^{2} da̱h^{2}: rmə̱r^{2} rtser^{2} swi̱w^{1} nwi^{2} ta^{1}, le^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rmə̱r^{2} rtser^{2} le^{2} nwi^{2}, le^{2} du^{1} lli̱w^{2} me^{1} ta^{1}, swi̱w^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}. swi̱w^{1} rmə̱r^{2} tha^{1} śe^{1}, yuo^{1} dźeh^{1} mi^{1} si^{1} ta^{1}, rtser^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. thə^{2} su^{2} rtser^{2} le^{2} ye^{1} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1} yə^{2} lə^{1}. nuo^{1} ryər^{1}: nvwi̱^{1} ndźe^{1} do̱^{2} rdzar^{2} rllər^{1} ye^{1} vwo̱^{2} ta^{1}, lləh^{1} kə^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}? ndze^{2} da̱h^{2}: a^{1} rlər^{2} le^{2} nwi^{2}, qu̱^{1} nvwi̱^{1} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}; le^{2} dźo? le^{2} rər^{2} nə^{2} tha̱^{1} śeṃ^{1} ta^{1}, ndźe^{1} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rqwə̱r^{1} le^{2} rtser^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rtser^{2} ta^{1} tśa^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}; tśa^{1} ta^{1} yuo^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}; yuo^{1} ta^{1} tha̱^{1} ŋwu̱^{2}. thə^{2} ta^{1} do̱^{2} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. rtser^{2} le^{2} rmə̱r^{2} si^{2} ŋa̱^{1} me^{1}, le^{2} lli̱w^{2} mi^{1} du^{1}, le^{2} ye^{1} le^{2} me^{1}, tśhow^{1} rdzar^{2} vwo̱^{2} ŋwu̱^{2}. ryər^{1} rmer^{2} thə^{2} bi̱h^{2} ghiw^{1} ġhwae̱^{1} dzu^{1} yu^{2}.*
Tibetan	ཛཡེས་རྱི། ཐའ་སྡའས། འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཡཡིས་ཏཡ་ཐཡིས་ཕྭོས་ཐཡེས་སོས།། འཛེས་སྡའས། རྨའིས་འརྩེས་སྭའིག་ནྭཡིས་ཏཡ། ལཡེས་ངྭུས།། རྨའིས་འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ནྭཡིས། ལཡེས་དཡུ་དའིགས་མཡེ་ཏཡ། སྭའིག་ངྭུས།། སྭའིག་རྨའིས་ཐཡ་ཤེ། ཡོུ་སྡེ་མཡི་སཡི་ཏཡ། འརྩེས་ངྭུས།། ཐཡིས་སཡུས་འརྩེས་ལཡེས་ཡཡེ་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཡཡིས་ལཡི།། ནྭོ་རྱི། འཕྭའི་འཛེ་དའོས་རྫས་འཛྲི་ཡཡེ་ཕྭོས་ཏཡ། སྡི་ཀཡི་ངྭུས།། འཛེས་སྡའས། ཨ+་འརླིས་ལཡེས་ནྭཡིས། ཀའུ་འཕྭའི་ཕྭོས་ངྭུས། ལཡེས་ཛོ?་ལཡེས་རྙིས་ནཡིས་ཐའ་ཤེམ་ཏཡ། འཛེ་ཕྭོས་ངྭུས།། རྐྭའི་ལཡེས་འརྩེས་ངྭུས།། འརྩེས་ཏཡ་ཙ་ངྭུས། ཙ་ཏཡ་ཡོུ་ངྭུས། ཡོུ་ཏཡ་ཐའ་ངྭུས།། ཐཡིས་ཏཡ་དའོས་ཕྭོས་ངྭུས།། འརྩེས་ལཡེས་རྨའིས་སཡིས་ངའ་མཡེ། ལཡེས་དའིགས་མཡི་དཡུ། ལཡེས་ཡཡེ་ལཡེས་མཡེ། ཚོག་རྫས་ཕྭོས་ངྭུས།། རྱི་རྨེས་ཐཡིས་སྦྲིས་གཡིག་གྭཨེ་ཛུ་ཡུས།།

7 Rhyme inventory

7.1 Main cycle (R.1–R.60)

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.1	1.01 [illegible]	2.01 [illegible]	*-u̱*	ཨའུ
R.2	1.02 [illegible]	2.02 [illegible]	*-u*	ཨུ
R.3	1.03 [illegible]	2.03 [illegible]	*-u*	ཨཡུ
R.4	1.04 [illegible]	2.04 [illegible]	*-u̱*	ཨའུ
R.5	1.05 [illegible]	2.05 [illegible]	*n- -u̱*	འཨའུ
R.6	1.06 [illegible]		*n- -au̱*	འཨཨུ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.7	1.07 [illegible]	2.06 [illegible]	*n- -u*	འཨུ
R.8	1.08 [illegible]	2.07 [illegible]	*-i̯*	ཨའི
R.9	1.09 [illegible]	2.08 [illegible]	*-ai̯*	ཨཨི
R.10	1.10 [illegible]	2.09 [illegible]	*-i*	ཨི
R.11	1.11 [illegible]	2.10 [illegible]	*-i*	ཨཡི
R.12	1.12 [illegible]	2.11 [illegible]	*n- -i̯*	འཨའི
R.13	1.13 [illegible]		*n- -ai̯*	འཨཨི
R.14	1.14 [illegible]	2.12 [illegible]	*n- -i*	འཨི
R.15	1.15 [illegible]	2.13 [illegible]	*-i̯ṃ*	ཨའིམ
R.16	1.16 [illegible]		*-iṃ*	ཨིམ
R.17	1.17 [illegible]	2.14 [illegible]	*-a̯*	ཨའ
R.18	1.18 [illegible]	2.15 [illegible]	*-aa̯*	ཨཨ
R.19	1.19 [illegible]	2.16 [illegible]	*-a*	ཨ
R.20	1.20 [illegible]	2.17 [illegible]	*-a*	ཨཡ
R.21	1.21 [illegible]	2.18 [illegible]	*-aw*	ཨག
R.22	1.22 [illegible]	2.19 [illegible]	*n- -a̯*	འཨའ
R.23		2.20 [illegible]	*n- -aa̯*	འཨཨ
R.24	1.23 [illegible]	2.21 [illegible]	*n- -a*	འཨ
R.25	1.24 [illegible]	2.22 [illegible]	*-a̯ṃ*	ཨའམ
R.26	1.25 [illegible]	2.23 [illegible]	*-aa̯ṃ*	ཨཨམ
R.27	1.26 [illegible]	2.24 [illegible]	*-aṃ*	ཨམ
R.28	1.27 [illegible]	2.25 [illegible]	*-ə̯*	ཨའེ
R.29	1.28 [illegible]	2.26 [illegible]	*-aə̯*	ཨཨེ
R.30	1.29 [illegible]	2.27 [illegible]	*-ə*	ཨེ
R.31	1.30 [illegible]	2.28 [illegible]	*-ə*	ཨཡེ
R.32	1.31 [illegible]		*n- -ə̯*	འཨའེ
R.33	1.32 [illegible]	2.29 [illegible]	*n- -ə*	འཨེ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.34	1.33 [illegible]	2.30 [illegible]	*-e̱*	ཨའེ
R.35	1.34 [illegible]	2.31 [illegible]	*-ae̱*	ཨཨེ
R.36	1.35 [illegible]	2.32 [illegible]	*-e*	ཨེ
R.37	1.36 [illegible]	2.33 [illegible]	*-e*	ཨཡེ
R.38	1.37 [illegible]	2.34 [illegible]	*n- -e̱*	འཨའེ
R.39	1.38 [illegible]		*n- -ae̱*	འཨཨེ
R.40	1.39 [illegible]	2.35 [illegible]	*n- -e*	འཨེ
R.41	1.40 [illegible]		*-e̱ṃ*	ཨའེམ
R.42	1.41 [illegible]	2.36 [illegible]	*-ae̱ṃ*	ཨཨེམ
R.43	1.42 [illegible]	2.37 [illegible]	*-eṃ*	ཨེམ
R.44	1.43 [illegible]	2.38 [illegible]	*-i̱w*	ཨའིག
R.45	1.44 [illegible]	2.39 [illegible]	*-ai̱w*	ཨཨིག
R.46	1.45 [illegible]	2.40 [illegible]	*-iw*	ཨིག
R.47	1.46 [illegible]		*-iw*	ཨཡིག
R.48		2.41 [illegible]	*n- -i̱w*	འཨའིག
R.49	1.47 [illegible]		*n- -iw*	འཨིག
R.50	1.48 [illegible]		*-ow*	ཨོག
R.51	1.49 [illegible]	2.42 [illegible]	*-o̱*	ཨའོ
R.52	1.50 [illegible]	2.43 [illegible]	*-ao̱*	ཨཨོ
R.53	1.51 [illegible]	2.44 [illegible]	*-o*	ཨོ
R.54	1.52 [illegible]	2.45 [illegible]	*n- -o̱*	འཨའོ
R.55	1.53 [illegible]	2.46 [illegible]	*n- -ao̱, n- -o*	འཨཨོ, འཨོ
R.56	1.54 [illegible]	2.47 [illegible]	*-o̱ṃ*	ཨའོམ
R.57	1.55 [illegible]	2.48 [illegible]	*-ao̱ṃ, -oṃ*	ཨཨོམ, ཨོམ
R.58	1.56 [illegible]	2.49 [illegible]	*-oṃ*	ཨོམ
R.59	1.57 [illegible]		*-uo*	ཨོུ

R.60		2.50 [illegible]	*(-uo?)*	ཇོུ

7.2 First minor cycle (R.61–R.76?): tense vowels *-h*

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.61	1.58 [illegible]	2.51 [illegible]	*-u̱h*	ཛྷའུ
R.62	1.59 [illegible]	2.52 [illegible]	*-au̱h*, *-uh*	ཛྷཨུ, ཛྷུ
R.63	1.60 [illegible]	2.53 [illegible]	*-e̱h*, *-ae̱h*	ཛྷའེ, ཛྷཨེ
R.64	1.61 [illegible]	2.54 [illegible]	*-eh*	ཛྷེ
R.65	1.62 [illegible]	2.55 [illegible]	*-eṃh*	ཛྷེམ
R.66	1.63 [illegible]	2.56 [illegible]	*-a̱h*	ཛྷའ
R.67	1.64 [illegible]	2.57 [illegible]	*-aa̱h*, *-ah*	ཛྷཨ, ཛྷ
R.68	1.65 [illegible]	2.58 [illegible]	*-i̱h*	ཛྷའི
R.69	1.66 [illegible]	2.59 [illegible]	*-ai̱h*	ཛྷཨི
R.70	1.67 [illegible]	2.60 [illegible]	*-ih*	ཛྷི
R.71	1.68 [illegible]		*-ə̱h*	ཛྷའྀ
R.72	1.69 [illegible]	2.61 [illegible]	*-aə̱h*, *-əh*	ཛྷཨྀ, ཛྷྀ
R.73	1.70 [illegible]	2.62 [illegible]	*-o̱ṃh*	ཛྷའོམ
R.74	1.71 [illegible]	2.63 [illegible]	*-o̱h*	ཛྷའོ
R.75	1.72 [illegible]	2.64 [illegible]	*-oh*	ཛྷོ
R.76		2.65 [illegible]	*(-ae̱ṃh?)*	ཛྷཨེམ

7.3 Second minor cycle (R.77?–R.98): retroflex vowels *r-...-r*

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.77	1.73 [illegible]	2.66 [illegible]	*r- -e̱r*	ཚའེ

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.78		2.67 [illegible]	*r- -a̠e̠r*	ཞཨེ
R.79	1.74 [illegible]	2.68 [illegible]	*r- -er*	ཞེ
R.80	1.75 [illegible]	2.69 [illegible]	*r- -u̠r*	ཞའུ
R.81	1.76 [illegible]	2.70 [illegible]	*r- -ur*	ཞུ
R.82	1.77 [illegible]	2.71 [illegible]	*r- -i̠r*	ཞའི
R.83	1.78 [illegible]		*r- -ai̠r*	ཞཨི
R.84	1.79 [illegible]	2.72 [illegible]	*r- -ir*	ཞི
R.85	1.80 [illegible]	2.73 [illegible]	*r- -a̠r*	ཞའ
R.86	1.81 [illegible]		*r- -aa̠r*	ཞཨ
R.87	1.82 [illegible]	2.74 [illegible]	*r- -ar*	ཞ
R.88	1.83 [illegible]		*n- -a̠r*	འཞའ
R.89		2.75 [illegible]	*r- -awr*	ཞག
R.90	1.84 [illegible]	2.76 [illegible]	*r- -ə̠r*	ཞའྀ
R.91	1.85 [illegible]		*r- -aə̠r*	ཞཨྀ
R.92	1.86 [illegible]	2.77 [illegible]	*r- -ər*	ཞྀ
R.93	1.87 [illegible]	2.78 [illegible]	*r- -i̠wr*	ཞའིག
R.94	1.88 [illegible]	2.79 [illegible]	*r- -iwr*	ཞིག
R.95	1.89 [illegible]	2.80 [illegible]	*r- -o̠r*	ཞའོ
R.96	1.90 [illegible]	2.81 [illegible]	*r- -ao̠r, r- -or*	ཞཨོ, ཞོ
R.97	1.91 [illegible]	2.82 [illegible]	*r- -o̠m̥r*	ཞའོམ
R.98		2.83 [illegible]	*(r- -om̥r?)*	ཞོམ

7.4 Miscellaneous categories (R.99–R.105)

	Level-tone section	Rising-tone section	GX	Tibetan
R.99		2.84 [illegible]	*(n- -e̠r?)*	འཚའེ
R.100	1.92 [illegible]	2.85 [illegible]	*(r- -ər?)*	འཚི
R.101	1.93 [illegible]	2.86 [illegible]	*(r- -er?)*	འཚེ
R.102	1.94 [illegible]		*(r- -or?)*	ཚོ
R.103	1.95 [illegible]		*(r- -or?)*	ཚོ
R.104	1.96 [illegible]		*-u̠ṃ*	ཨཙུམ
R.105	1.97 [illegible]		*(r- -ar?)*	ཚ